

PLANTAR FASCIITIS

TIPS & STRETCHES TO HELP YOU FEEL BETTER



Plantar fasciitis causes heel pain and stiffness, especially with the first steps in the morning or after long periods of rest. Use these tips and stretches to reduce pain and support healing.



SUPPORTIVE SHOES

Wear supportive shoes with good arch support and cushioning. Avoid walking barefoot or wearing flat, unsupportive shoes.



ICE AFTER ACTIVITY

Apply ice to the bottom of your foot for 15–20 minutes after activity to help reduce pain and inflammation.



STRETCH DAILY

Tight calf muscles and the plantar fascia can increase heel pain. Stretching daily can improve flexibility and reduce tension.



MASSAGE YOUR FOOT

Roll your foot on a frozen water bottle, tennis ball, or massage ball for several minutes each day.



MANAGE ACTIVITY & WEIGHT

Reduce high-impact activities that increase pain. Maintaining a healthy weight can reduce stress on your feet.



TAKE BREAKS

Avoid long periods of standing or walking. Take breaks and rest when needed.



BE PATIENT & CONSISTENT

Plantar fasciitis can take time to heal. Consistent stretching and self-care are key to recovery.

WHEN TO SEEK CARE

Seek medical attention if you experience:

- Pain that lasts more than a few weeks despite self-care
- Severe pain that limits daily activities
- Numbness, tingling, or weakness in your foot
- Swelling, redness, or warmth
- Pain after an injury



Pain is usually worst with the first steps in the morning or after sitting or resting for a while.

GENTLE STRETCHES FOR PLANTAR FASCIITIS

1 PLANTAR FASCIA STRETCH



- Sit with your leg crossed over your other knee.
- Grasp your toes and gently pull them back toward your shin until you feel a stretch in the bottom of your foot.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times.

2 TOWEL STRETCH



- Sit with your leg straight out. Loop a towel around the ball of your foot.
- Gently pull the towel toward you, keeping your knee straight until you feel a stretch in the bottom of your foot and calf.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times.

3 CALF WALL STRETCH



- Stand facing a wall with your hands on the wall.
- Step one foot back and keep your heel down.
- Lean forward until you feel a stretch in your calf.
- Hold for 20–30 seconds.
- Repeat 2–3 times each leg.

4 TOWEL CURLS



- Sit in a chair with a towel on the floor.
- Use your toes to scrunch the towel toward you.
- Slowly release and repeat.
- Do for 1–2 minutes.



Listen to your body. These stretches should not cause sharp pain. Stop if you feel increased pain and consult a healthcare provider.

IF YOUR SYMPTOMS PERSIST OR WORSEN, PLEASE FOLLOW UP WITH YOUR PROVIDER.

This handout is for educational purposes only and is not a substitute for professional medical advice. Always consult your healthcare provider with any questions or concerns.